

Support troubleshooting field handbook

Evidence-first triage for Acme Automations

The first five minutes

Record customer impact, start time, organization, integration, environment, and two representative run IDs. Separate what the customer observed from the suspected cause. Do not retry, resume, rotate, or reroute anything until the current state is preserved.

Authentication 4xx	Usually permanent; inspect credentials before retry
HTTP 429	Transient; honor Retry-After and scheduled backoff
HTTP 502	Usually transient; compare identical successful retries
Queue delay	Check region and incident timeline before customer config

Intermittent 502 workflow

Compare the same payload across failed and successful attempts. If an unchanged payload succeeds automatically, the evidence points to a transient gateway, destination, or network condition rather than a deterministic payload defect. Calculate the rolling error rate, correlate incident time and region, and escalate when retries exhaust or the rate remains above one percent.

Evidence quality

Prefer current documentation and direct operational records. Mark superseded pages as historical rather than silently using them. A useful conclusion cites the exact source and states what remains uncertain.

Action safety

Read freely; write only with intent

Read-only investigation

Documentation search, organization lookup, integration state, run history, logs, and incident timelines do not change customer state. Use them to build a timeline and test a specific hypothesis.

Approval-gated actions

Retries, resumes, pauses, route changes, credential changes, ticket updates, and customer messages require an explicit support-engineer decision. The proposed action must include the evidence, expected effect, risk, and an idempotency key when supported.

Escalation packet

Scope	Organizations, regions, environments, and affected components.
Timeline	First observation, representative runs, and current state in UTC.
Evidence	Current docs, logs, incidents, and disconfirming observations.
Actions	What was attempted, who approved it, and the measured result.

Definition of done

The root cause is supported by retrieved evidence, the recommended action is bounded, verification succeeded, and the customer-facing explanation distinguishes confirmed facts from remaining uncertainty.